Casey Caster

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Engineering operations and strategy executive with 15+ years running the operating engine behind technology organizations in cloud infrastructure, B2B SaaS, and fintech. As chief of staff to the CPO and then the CTO at SingleStore, manages the engineering budget with Finance, runs engineering capacity planning and delivery dashboards, negotiates with vendors including on LLM token pricing, built a COGS intelligence engine with Finance, and cut internal cloud spend 50%. Leads AI tooling across the development stack, including Claude Code, and integrated acquired teams after M&A. Executive MBA (Cornell and Queen's); PMP.

Core Competencies

- **Engineering Budget Governance & Cost Modeling**: Manages the engineering budget with Finance; built a COGS intelligence engine with Finance that aligns growth trends with operational investment decisions.
- **AI Token Spend & Consumption-Based Cost Optimization**: Negotiates LLM token pricing and usage commitments; cut internal cloud spend 50% through usage modeling and policy reform.
- **Vendor Operations & Contract Negotiation**: Negotiates with vendors at SingleStore; negotiated and fulfilled customer SOWs and MSAs with enterprise financial institutions at Ripple.
- **Workforce & Capacity Planning**: Runs engineering capacity planning for engineering leadership; scaled Ripple's delivery organization from 4 project managers to 25, and led 75+ engineers and architects indirectly.
- **Operating Cadence & Executive Reporting**: Delivery dashboards and accountability systems for engineering leadership; 5x engineering velocity; Jira, Confluence, Looker, Tableau, Power BI, SQL.
- **AI-First Operations & Post-Acquisition Integration**: Leads AI tooling and GenAI governance, including Claude Code; led M&A technical due diligence and integrated acquired teams into core systems.

Professional Experience

- **SingleStore** **San Francisco, CA**
  Sr Director, Engineering - Internal Services & Technical Program Management (CTO Chief of Staff) *2021-Present*
  Strategy and operations for a cloud-native database company in hypergrowth, reporting to the CPO and then the CTO. Leads seven teams through 6 direct reports, including a director and two managers (32 people: 28 FTEs and 4 contractors). Owns cost optimization, M&A, governance, and AI platform operations programs.
  - **Manages the engineering budget with Finance**, and built a COGS intelligence engine with Finance that aligns growth trends with operational investment decisions.
  - **Negotiates with vendors, including LLM token pricing** and usage commitments.
  - **Cut internal cloud spend by 50%** through cross-team policy reform and usage modeling.
  - **Runs engineering capacity planning and delivery dashboards** for engineering leadership.
  - **De-risked M&A** by leading technical due diligence and merger analysis, then integrating acquired teams into core systems and workflows.
  - **Drove internal GenAI adoption** with a governance and ops program; leads tooling and AI enablement across the development stack, including Claude Code.
  - **Unlocked $30M+ in recurring ARR** by stepping in to lead a failing strategic partner integration to successful delivery.
  - **Increased engineering velocity 5x** through agile transformation and accountability systems; launched an internal development platform that cut infrastructure bottlenecks 70%.

- **Ripple, Inc.** **San Francisco, CA**
  Global Head of Program Management, Customer Success *2016-2020*
  Promoted to lead global delivery programs for RippleNet and architect the implementation function.
  - **Built the global delivery organization** across four regions, from 4 project managers to three managers of project management and 25 project managers, and led 75+ engineers and architects indirectly.
  - **Delivered 800+ global implementations** and cut customer delivery time from eight months to eight weeks.
  - **Negotiated and fulfilled customer SOWs and MSAs** with enterprise financial institutions as part of customer care and infrastructure strategy.
  - **Oversaw a joint venture in Japan** that delivered implementations at 68+ additional banks.

- **Wells Fargo Bank** **San Francisco, CA**
  Senior Program Manager *2014-2015*
  - **Delivered a $20M+ digital transformation initiative**, coordinating 300+ testers.
  - **Led an upgrade of project portfolio systems** for 10,000+ vendors.

- **Autodesk** **San Francisco, CA**
  Senior Program Manager, Head of Continuous Improvement *2013-2014*
  - **Led portfolio optimization with $2M+ in savings** and improved user satisfaction.
  - Analyzed 150+ projects and delivered recommendations to improve efficiency and employee engagement.

- **Engajer** **Mountain View, CA**
  Head of Customer Success *2012-2013*
  - Built and led programs supporting 850+ customers; increased revenue 20% per account with 85% retention.

- **Avanade** **San Francisco, CA**
  Senior Consultant *2010-2012*
  - IT consulting across application services and digital transformation; delivered CRM and communications transformations in utilities and healthcare.

Selected Accomplishments

- **Oversaw a $4M virtual testing network program** with teams in Bangalore, India, and London, saving hundreds of person-hours per test cycle.
- **Delivered 250+ concurrent global projects** and 800+ over three years at Ripple.
- **Mentored dozens of team members**, three of whom became CEOs at other companies.

Education & Certifications

- **Executive MBA**, Cornell University (Johnson) and Queen's University (Smith), dual degree
- **BS, Electronic Engineering Technology**, DeVry University, Pomona, CA
- **Project Management Professional (PMP)**, Project Management Institute

References

- Available upon request.